TECHACKS 5.0

15-16 JAN 2027

FLIGHT RULES

Code of Conduct



INTRODUCTION

TecHacks is a community hackathon built for collaboration and learning. Our vision is to make it easy for anyone to dream big. We value every member of the community and want everyone to have an enjoyable, fulfilling experience, so all attendees are expected to show respect and courtesy to each other throughout the event.

This Code of Conduct applies to **everyone** at TecHacks 5.0, in person and online: hackers, mentors, judges, volunteers, sponsors and organisers. Organisers will enforce it throughout the event.

OUR CORE VALUES

01 Inclusivity

Everyone gets a seat at the table, even when they are not in the room. Show respect and make sure people feel valued and heard.

02 Diversity

Our differences make us stronger, kinder and more competitive. Different perspectives lead to better ideas.

03 Learning

“No one knows everything; together we know a lot.” Learn from each other and share what you know.

04 Self-care

You do your best work when you are rested. Notice when you are stretched too thin. Rest, revitalise, repeat.

05 Feedback

Be generous in giving and accepting it. Good feedback is kind, clear, specific and about the work, not the person.

06 Communication

Share early, ask often, and be polite everywhere. Intent and impact can differ, especially online, so say what you mean.

07 Listening

Listen to understand, not to reply. Stay open-minded, avoid getting defensive, and leave room for play and curiosity.

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

How we fly together

- **Be supportive.** Offer help when you see someone struggling, or point them to someone who can. Generous feedback is one way to show it.
- **Be inclusive.** Avoid cliques, avoid slang or idioms that may not translate across cultures and languages, and be an ally when a teammate needs one.
- **Be collaborative.** Share early and ask for feedback often, whether it is a brainstorm, a code review or a midnight snack run.
- **Be kind.** To others and to yourself. Be polite and courteous on every channel: on the floor, on Discord and on social media.

PROTECTED GROUNDS

This policy prohibits harassment or discrimination based on any of the following grounds, or any combination of them:

- Age
- Creed (religion)
- Sex (including pregnancy and breastfeeding)
- Sexual orientation
- Gender identity
- Gender expression
- Disability (mental, physical, developmental or learning)
- Race
- Ancestry
- Place of origin
- Ethnic origin
- Citizenship
- Colour
- Any other grounds the organisers deem inappropriate



Treat people the way you want to be treated.

When in doubt, ask yourself whether you would be comfortable if everyone in the room could see what you are doing.

PROHIBITED BEHAVIOUR

Not on this flight

Harassment
Comments or actions that are known, or ought reasonably to be known, to be unwelcome: offensive, embarrassing, humiliating or demeaning words or actions, based on one or more incidents.

Discrimination
Any direct or indirect unequal treatment of others, intentional or not, that imposes extra burdens or denies benefits to certain groups of people.

Abusive behaviour and lewd conduct
Using any device or channel (in person, Discord, social media) for illegal, lewd, offensive, indecent, sexual or obscene acts or expression, or to harass or bully.

Sexual and gender-based harassment
Including leering or inappropriate staring; gender-related verbal abuse, threats or taunting; unwelcome demands for dates; requests for sexual favours; displays of sexually offensive images or recordings; and offensive jokes or comments of a sexual nature.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Everyone at TecHacks is expected to uphold this policy: refrain from harassment and discrimination, and cooperate fully with any investigation of a complaint. Organisers must act immediately on anything they observe or are told about, and address potential problems before they become serious. If someone breaks this code, organisers may take any action they consider appropriate, including a warning or removal from the event.

If TecHacks 5.0 runs as an MLH Member Event, the **MLH Code of Conduct** applies as well. CONFIRM MLH

See something? Say something.

REPORTING

STEP 1
Tell an organiser
Talk to any organiser, in person or on Discord.

STEP 2
Or write to us
hi@techacks.tech · [dedicated reporting contact]

STEP 3
We act
Organisers handle reports with care and discretion, and may warn or remove anyone who breaks this code.